Leave Policy

Brightpath Technologies Pvt. Ltd. | Document ID: BP-HR-002 | Version 3.1

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1. Purpose

This policy defines the types of leave available to employees of Brightpath Technologies, how leave is earned, applied for, approved and encashed. It aims to support rest, health and family needs while ensuring business continuity.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all full-time and part-time employees on the company payroll in India. Interns and contract staff are governed by the terms of their individual agreements. The leave year runs from 1 January to 31 December.

3. Leave entitlements at a glance

Leave type	Annual entitlement	How it is credited	Carry forward	Encashable
Earned Leave (EL)	18 working days	1.5 days at the end of each month worked	Yes, up to 30 days total	Yes, on exit only
Casual Leave (CL)	8 working days	Credited on 1 January (pro-rated for new joiners)	No, lapses on 31 Dec	No
Sick Leave (SL)	10 working days	Credited on 1 January (pro-rated for new joiners)	Yes, up to 20 days total	No
Maternity Leave	26 weeks	On eligibility	Not applicable	No
Paternity Leave	10 working days	On birth or adoption	Must be used within 6 months	No
Bereavement Leave	5 working days per event	On request	Not applicable	No
Marriage Leave	5 working days, once in employment	On request	Not applicable	No
Compensatory Off	1 day per holiday or weekend worked	On manager approval	Expires in 60 days	No

4. Earned Leave

- Earned Leave accrues at 1.5 days for each completed month of service, i.e. 18 days per year.
- For leave of up to 3 days, apply at least 7 calendar days in advance. For leave of more than 3 days, apply at least 15 calendar days in advance.
- A maximum of 30 days of Earned Leave can be carried forward to the next leave year. Any balance above 30 days lapses on 31 December.
- Employees on probation accrue Earned Leave from the date of joining but may use it only after confirmation.

- With HR approval, an employee may take up to 3 days of Earned Leave in advance (negative balance), adjusted against future accrual.

5. Casual Leave

- Casual Leave is meant for short, unplanned personal needs.
- Casual Leave cannot be taken for more than 3 consecutive working days.
- Casual Leave cannot be combined with Earned Leave in the same continuous absence.
- Half-day Casual Leave is permitted.
- Unused Casual Leave lapses at the end of the leave year and is not encashable.

6. Sick Leave

- Sick Leave may be applied for on the day of absence or within 2 working days of returning.
- A medical certificate from a registered medical practitioner is required for Sick Leave of more than 2 consecutive days.
- Up to 20 days of unused Sick Leave may be carried forward.
- If Sick Leave is exhausted, the absence is debited from Earned Leave, and then treated as Loss of Pay.

7. Maternity, adoption and paternity leave

Female employees who have worked for at least 80 days in the 12 months preceding the expected date of delivery are eligible for 26 weeks of paid maternity leave for the first two children, of which up to 8 weeks may be taken before delivery. For the third child onward, maternity leave is 12 weeks.

Employees adopting a child below 3 months of age are eligible for 12 weeks of adoption leave. In case of miscarriage or medical termination of pregnancy, 6 weeks of paid leave is granted.

Male employees are eligible for 10 working days of paid paternity leave, which must be taken within 6 months of the child's birth or adoption. It may be taken in a maximum of two blocks.

8. Holidays

The company declares 12 fixed public holidays per calendar year, published by HR in December for the following year. In addition, each employee may choose 2 optional (floating) holidays from the published optional holiday list. Unused optional holidays lapse at year end.

9. Sandwich rule

When Earned Leave is taken for 5 or more consecutive working days, weekends and public holidays that fall between the leave days are counted as leave. For leave shorter than 5 working days, intervening weekends and holidays are not counted.

10. Applying for leave

- All leave must be applied for in the PeopleHub HR portal.
- Managers must approve or reject leave requests within 2 working days. Requests not acted on within 2 working days are escalated to the skip-level manager.
- Leave taken without approval is treated as unauthorised absence and may be marked Loss of Pay.
- Unauthorised absence for 3 or more consecutive working days without contact will result in an absconding notice being issued.

- Work from home days are not leave and must be recorded separately in PeopleHub.

11. Leave encashment

Earned Leave is encashed only at the time of separation. A maximum of 30 days is encashable, calculated as (monthly basic salary / 26) multiplied by the number of encashable days. Casual Leave, Sick Leave and Compensatory Off are not encashable.

12. Loss of Pay

When an employee has no applicable leave balance, absence is treated as Loss of Pay (LOP). One day of LOP is calculated as monthly gross salary divided by the number of calendar days in that month.

13. Contact

Questions about this policy can be raised with your HR Business Partner or by email to hr-helpdesk@brightpath.example.